CBSE Class 10

English (Language and Literature)

Previous Year Question Paper 2020

Series: JBB/5 **Set- 1**

Code no. 2/5/1

- Please check that this paper contains 8 printed pages.
- Code number given on the right-hand side of the question paper should be written on the title page of the answer-book by the candidate.
- Please check that this question paper contains 11 questions.
- **Please write down the Serial Number of the question in the answer-book before attempting it.**
- 15 minutes of time has been allotted to read this question paper. The question paper will be distributed at 10.15 a.m. From 10.15 a.m. to 10.30 a.m., the students will read the question paper only and will not write any answer on the answer-book during this period.

ENGLISH (Language and Literature)

Time Allowed: **3** hours Maximum Marks: **80**

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions very carefully and strictly follow them.

1. The question paper comprises three sections - A. B and C.

Section A - 20 marks

Section B - 30 marks

Section C - 30 marks

2. There are 11 questions in the question paper. All questions are compulsory.

3. Answers should be brief and to the point.

4. There is no overall choice in the question proper. However, an internal choice has been provided in Section B and Section C. Make your choices correctly.

5. In addition to this, separate instructions are given with each section and question, wherever necessary.

6. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

SECTION – A

(Reading) **20 Marks**

1. Read the following passage carefully. **8 Marks**

1 Caged behind thick glass, the most famous dancer in the world can easily be missed in the National Museum, Delhi. The Dancing Girl of Mohenjo - daro is that rare artefact that even school children are familiar with. Our school textbooks also communicate the wealth of our 5000-year heritage of art. You have to be alert to her existence there, amid terracotta animals to rediscover this bronze image.

2 Most of us have seen her only in photographs or sketches. Therefore, the impact of actually holding her is magnified a million times over. One discovers that the dancing girl has no feet. She is small, a little over 10 cm tall — the length of a human palm — but she surprises us with the power of great art — the ability to communicate across centuries.

3 A series of bangles — of shell or ivory or thin metal — clothe her left upper arm all the way down to her fingers. A necklace with three pendants bunched together and a few bangles above the elbow and wrist on the right hand display an almost modern art.

4 She speaks of the undaunted, ever hopeful human spirit. She reminds us that it is important to visit museums in our country to experience the impact that a work of art leaves on our senses, to find among all the riches

one particular vision of beauty that speaks to us alone.

1.1 On the basis of your reading of the above passage, answer the following questions. 1x8=8 Marks

(a) The Dancing Girl belongs to

(i) Mohenjo - daro.

(ii) Greek culture.

(iii) Homo sapiens.

(iv) Tibet.

Ans: (i) Mohenjo - daro

(b) In the museum she's, kept among

(i) dancing figures.

(ii) bronze statues.

(iii) terracotta animals.

(iv) books.

Ans: (iii) terracotta animals.

(c) Which information is not given in the passage?

(i) The girl is caged behind glass.

(ii) She is a rare artefact.

(iii) School books communicate the wealth of our heritage.

(iv) She cannot be rediscovered as she's bronze.

Ans: (iv) She cannot be rediscovered as she's bronze.

(d) 'Great Art' has power because

(i) it appeals to us despite a passage of time.

(ii) it is small and can be understood.

(iii) it is seen in pictures and sketches.

(iv) it is magnified a million times.

Ans: (i) it appeals to us despite a passage of time.

(e) The jewellery she wears

(i) consists of bangles of shell or ivory or thin metal only.

(ii) is a necklace with two pendants.

(iii) Both (i) and (ii) are correct.

(iv) Neither (i) nor (ii) is correct.

Ans: (i) consists of bangles of shell or ivory or thin metal only.

(f) She reminds us

(i) of the never-say-die attitude of humans.

(ii) why museums in our country are exciting.

(iii) why she will make us come into money.

(iv) of dancing figures.

Ans: (ii) why museums in our country are exciting.

(g) The synonym of the word "among" in paragraph 1 is ____.

Ans: among-amid

(h) The size of the dancing girl is equal to the length of the human plan. (True/False)

Ans: True

2. Read the following passage carefully: 12 Marks

1 As the family finally sets off from home after many arguments, there is a moment of lull as the car takes off. "Alright, so where are we going for dinner now?" asks the one at the driving wheel. What follows is chaos as

multiple voices make as many suggestions.

2 By the time order is restored and a decision is arrived at, tempers have risen, feelings injured and there is at least one person grumbling.

3 Twenty years ago, you would step out of home, the decision of meal and venue already made with no arguments or opposition and everybody looked forward to the meal with equal enthusiasm. The decision was made by the head of the family and the others fell in line. Today every member of the family has a say in every decision which also promotes a sense of togetherness and bonding.

4 We empower our kids to make their own decisions from a very early age. We ask them the cuisine they prefer, the movie they want to see, the holiday they wish to go on and the subjects they wish to study.

5 It's a closely connected world out there where children consult and guide each other. A parent's well-meaning advice can sound like nothing more than unnecessary preaching. How then do we reach our children through all the conflicting views and make the voice of reason be heard? Child day questions choices and prefer to go with the flow.

6 What then is the best path to take? I would say the most important thing one can do is to listen. Listen to your children and their silences. Ensure that you keep some time aside for them, insist that they share their stories with you. Step into their world. It is not as complicated as it sounds; just a daily half an hour of quality time would do the trick.

2.1 On the basis of your reading of the above passage, answer the following questions in 30 - 40 words each: 2x4=8 Marks

(a) Write one advantage and one disadvantage of allowing every family member to be a part of the decision-making process.

Ans: One advantage is that the decision-making process fosters a sense of belonging and camaraderie.

Disadvantage - It might lead to squabbling and strife.

(b) In today's world, what are parents asking their kids?

Ans: In today's environment, we let our children make their own judgments from a young age. Today, every member of the family has a say in every decision, which fosters a sense of belonging and bonding. From a young age, we provide

our children the ability to make their own judgments.We ask them the cuisine they prefer, the movie they want to see, the holiday they wish to go on and the subjects they wish to study.

(c) Which two pieces of advice does the writer give to the parents?

Ans: Both pieces of advice, the writer give to the parents are:-

- Pay attention to your children's silences, listen to your children and their silences. Ensure that you keep some time aside for them.
- Spend time with your children and tell them your stories.Just a daily half an hour of quality time would do the trick.

(d) The passage supports the parents. How far do you agree with the author's views? Support your view with a reason.

Ans: Yes, I agree that this passage supports the parents because the decision was taken by the family's head twenty years ago, and it encourages a sense of togetherness and bonding. I agree with this viewpoint because youngsters do not have the ability to make their own decisions. Make sound decisions on your own. It is possible that it is incorrect at times.

2.2 On the basis of your reading of the above passage, answer the following: 1x4=4 Marks

(a) The synonym of 'hurt' as given in paragraph 2 is _____.

Ans: injured

(b) The word which means the same as 'a style or method of cooking' in paragraph 4 is

(i) cuisine

(ii) gourmet

(iii) gastric

(iv) science

Ans: cuisine

(c) The antonym of 'agreeable' as given in paragraph 5 is ____.

Ans: conflicting

(d) The antonym of 'simple' as given in paragraph 6 is

(i) difficult

(ii) complicated

(iii) easy

(iv) tricky

Ans: complicated

SECTION - B

(Writing and Grammar) 30 marks

3. You are Mukesh/Manju living at 7/31, Karla Nagar, Kanpur. There are many stray dogs in your colony. They chase vehicles, trouble strangers and sometimes bite the children. They are a nuisance. Write a letter of complaint to the Municipal Commissioner, Kanpur requesting him to instruct the concerned staff to take appropriate action. (100 - 150 wards) 8 Marks

Ans: 7/31,

Kamla Nagar,

Kanpur

5th April 2020

The Municipal Commissioner,

Kanpur

Uttar Pradesh

Dear sir,

With great respect and humble submission, I, Mukesh / Manju, would like to inform you of the troubles that the residents of my colony at 7/31, Kanpur, are experiencing as a result of stray dogs that are always roaming in and around our

street.

These stray dogs arrived approximately two weeks ago and are causing a slew of issues for the locals. These dogs chase the vehicles that come and go from our street, making it difficult for many people, particularly those with children, to leave their homes to buy vital goods.Not only have these stray dogs begun assaulting residents, but one of them recently bit a child who was playing with his buddies in the park. Many residents have written letters of complaint to the municipality, but no action has been taken. As a result, we would like to ask you to be so kind as to look into and address our problem, for which we would be eternally grateful.

Thank you

Yours sincerely

Manju

Or

You are Sarita/Saurabh. Your school organised an adult literacy camp. Many people benefited from it. You realised the importance of educating the adults. Write an article on 'Importance of Adult Education' for your school magazine in 100 - 150 words. 8 Marks

Ans: "Importance of adult education"

By-Sarita/Sourav

You've probably heard about the adult literacy camp that we conducted earlier this month. It drew the active participation of a large number of our school's pupils and benefited over a hundred illiterate persons in our community. As you are all aware, being able to read and write is a talent that we all require. Unfortunately, many of us are still robbed of the opportunity to learn and cannot even write our own names. We can help kids learn and make a difference in their life by organising camps like these.

Everyone who attended the programme was ecstatic about the opportunity to learn. The school's literacy club has already provided them with certain study materials, and it has also been arranged to hold these learning sessions on our school grounds every Sunday from 1.30 to 5.30. While several students have already expressed an interest in teaching at the future sessions, there may be many more who wish to volunteer. If you want to be a part of this goal to educate adults, please contact the Literary Club secretary and register your name. It is

not difficult to eradicate illiteracy if each individual teaches another.

It is not difficult to eradicate illiteracy if each individual teaches another. It is unfortunate that even in the twenty-first century, millions of individuals are unable to read or write. So, let us all take use of this opportunity to teach and contribute.

4. Complete the following story in 150 - 200 words: 10 Marks

It was my cousin's wedding. Preparations were being made for the departure of the baraat. But suddenly ... ...

Ans: My cousin's wedding was taking place. Preparations were being made for the baraat's departure. But then we noticed that our great grandfather, the patriarch of our family, Bade Dadaji, with his wheelchair had vanished! We couldn't go further without him, but he was nowhere to be seen! The path from the house's front door to the bus parked outside was rather clear. We asked everyone - helpers, guests, neighbours - and no one had any idea. The kids were too busy chasing each other to help. The bus driver approached us twenty minutes later, apparently upset by the delay.

Before we could say anything about the holdup, the man, practically in tears, begged, 'Please, please, can we leave as quickly as possible?' I'm having a difficult time. I've been forced to listen to an elderly man's driving instructions for the past half hour. I don't believe I can take it anymore.'

While the man's eyes were filled with tears of agony, ours were filled with excitement! The driver was nearly insane, but Bade Dadaji had been discovered! Bade Dadaji had requested that the bus conductor carry him over to the driver's side of the bus, where he had been all along.

Or

Taking help from the cues given below, develop a story in 150- 200 words: 10 Marks

A boy fails in bad company — father brings apples — puts them in a basket — places a rotten apple among them — the next day all apples rotten — teaches a lesson to the boy.

Ans: Awful Company

Once upon a time, a young man became involved with some terrible company. He wasted his time by hanging out with bad boys. It irritated his father. He tried everything he could to rectify him, but he was unsuccessful.

One day, the father had an idea. He visited the market and purchased some fresh apples. He also brought a rotten apple with him. "Place the decaying apples in the basket, then all these apples in the almirah," he instructed his kid. This was done by the youngsters.

The father asked him to deliver the fruit the next day. The fruit was taken from the almirah by the youngster. When the boy saw the apples, he was disappointed. They were all bad. "Once a bad apple has destroyed all the good ones," the father observed. Bad pals are analogous to bad apples. They'll shower you with gifts." These words had a mystical effect on me. The child realised his mistake and stopped hanging out with nasty people, returning to his previous level of decency.

The conclusion of the story is that one bad friend can ruin all of your good ones.

5. Read the paragraph given below and fill in the blanks by choosing the most appropriate words from the given options. 1x4=4 Marks

After (a) _____a week in the cottage, he decided that he didn't really enjoy (b) _____in the countryside and began (c) _____as an excuse for (d) _____the cottage.

(a) (i) spending (ii) have spent (iii) spent (iv) spends

Ans: spending

(b) (i) to living (ii) lived (iii) living (iv) lives

Ans : living

(c) (i) to thinking (ii) to thought (iii) thought (iv) to think

Ans: to think

(d) (i) sold (ii) selling (iii) sells (iv) sale

Ans: selling

6. The following paragraph has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the error and the correction in your answer book against the correct blank number. 1x4=4 Marks

Error Correction

Today the girls have broke the **(a) _____ _____**

five-foot barrier and on some **(b) _____ _____**

cases is a half foot taller **(c) _____ _____**

then their grandmothers **(d) _____ _____**

Ans:

ERROR	CORRECTION
broke	Broken
On	in
Is	are
then	than

7. Rearrange the following words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. 1x4=4 Marks

(a) Ramesh / the park / a boy / met / one day / in

Ans: One day, Ramesh met a boy in the park.

(b) was / old / young boy / seven years / the / only

Ans: The young boy was only seven years old.

(c) asked / the nearest / he / bookstore / about / him

Ans: He asked him about the nearest bookstore.

(d) wanted / buy / he / to / books / a few

Ans: He wanted to buy a few books.

SECTION - C

(Literature) **30 Marks**

7. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

1x4=4 Marks

"Never shall a young man,

Thrown into despair

By those great honey-coloured

Ramparts at your ear,

Love you for yourself alone

And not your yellow hair."

(a) The lady's hair is compared to _____.

(i) ramparts

(ii) ears

(iii) honey

(iv) despair

Ans: honey

(b) The young man has fallen in love with the lady for her ____.

(i) wealth

(ii) social position

(iii) looks

(iv) mind

Ans: looks

Or

Ausable moved to an armchair and sat down heavily. "I'm going to raise

the devil with the management this time, and you can bet on it," he said grimly. "This is the second time in a month that somebody has gotten into my room through that nuisance of a balcony!" 1x4=4 Marks

(a) Who is Ausable?

(i) A secret agent

(ii) A tourist in a hotel

(iii) A reporter

(iv) A businessman

Ans: A secret agent

(b) Why was Ausable angry with the management?

(i) His room was unsafe.

(ii) The food was not good.

(iii) The balcony was a nuisance.

(iv) The armchair was not soft.

Ans: His room was unsafe.

(c) Was there a balcony with the room? Yes/No.

Ans: No

(d) Ausable was playing a _____ on his visitor.

Ans: trick/joke

9. Answer any five of the following questions in 30 - 40 words each: 2x5=10 Marks

(a) Did the letter reach God? Why did the postmaster send a reply to Lencho?

Ans: The letter was not delivered to the god.Because he didn't want to jeopardise his great faith in God, the mailman responded to Lencho.As a result, the postal

delivered the 70 pesos to the lencho. The postmaster and post office staff gathered 70 from his own earnings and sent it to Lencho.

(b) What does Mandela refer to as 'an extraordinary human disaster'?

Ans: Nelson Mandela referred to it as "an extraordinary human disaster" because it was the practise of South African apartheid. During the apartheid government, people were separated based on their skin colour. Black people lacked adequate constitutional rights.

(c) What is the central idea of the poem, 'Animals'?

Ans: In his poem "Animals," Walt Whitman praises animals for being superior to humans and possessing all of the characteristics that humans lack or have forgotten. These qualities include serenity, a lack of avarice, and the ability to remain satisfied and restrained. The poet wants to live among animals and live a life free of complaints, flaws, and sadness.

(d) Why does Anil not hand Hari Singh over to the police?

Ans: Anil refuses to turn over the thief to the authorities because he believes Hari has learned his lesson and changed for the better. When he discovered that Hari had stolen the money but kept it, he realised that it was Hari's conscience that had compelled him to do so.

(e) Why did Ebright lose interest in tagging butterflies?

Ans: Ebright used to brand butterflies' wings and then release them. In reality, thousands of monarch butterflies lived in the basement of his house. He began to lose interest in it because it was a monotonous job with little feedback.

(f) Why did Bholi not marry Bishamber?

Ans: Bholi was devoted to her parents and for their sake respect and pleasure she agreed to marry Bishamber. When Bishamber wanted 5,000 rupees as dowry and insulted her father, she refused to marry him in order to safeguard Ramlal's dignity.

10. How did the Buddha make Kisa Gotami realise the reality of death? (100 - 160 words) 8 Marks

Ans: Kisa Gotami was bereaved at her son's death and sought Buddha, pleading

with him to provide her medicine so that her son may live again. Buddha requested that she bring him a handful of mustard seeds from a residence where no one had perished. However, Kisa Gotami was unable to locate such a residence. She suddenly realised that death is unavoidable and that no one can avoid it.

Later, in his talk, The Buddha told her that life is short and terrible. He compares life to an earthen pot, claiming that just as the pot would break, so will life. A knowledgeable person does not weep because he is aware of the truth. Weeping does not provide mental tranquilly. Only those who have learned to control their grief will be at peace.

Or

"Valli was a mature girl and ahead of her age." Justify the statement with instances from the text. (100 - 150 words) 8 Marks

Ans: Valli was a country girl of eight years old. Her favourite pastime was standing on her front porch and watching objects and people go by. Not only did she satisfy her curiosity, but she also obtained new experiences. She was wise, astute, and sensible for her age. Her main wish was to ride the bus. She painstakingly planned for it, obtaining data on distance, ticket price, and fare. She was determined to avoid any temptation, such as buying peppermint, toys, or a ride on the merry-go-round, in order to save sixty paise for the bus ride. She boarded the bus without anyone's assistance. She disliked being addressed as 'Madam' or 'Child.' She refused the conductor's free treat and avoided strangers. This demonstrates her dominating, assertive, and self-sufficient personality. This also demonstrates her maturity and dedication for her age.

11. Mme Forestier proved to be a true friend of the Loisels. Elaborate. (100 — 150 words) 8 Marks

Ans: Mme Forestier proved to be a loyal Loisels' friend. Mme Forestier was an important character in the plot. She sincerely assisted Matilda when she needed her. Matilda had a gorgeous figure and always felt she was born for a family of luxuries rather than a family of clerks. She lacked the opulent lifestyle she desired. As a result, she was dissatisfied with her existence. While she was constantly envious of Mme. Forestier's lavish lifestyle, Mme. Forestier was a devoted companion. When Matilda requested for a necklace, she showed her a plethora of jewels and did not hesitate. Even after Matilda had lost the necklace and replaced it, she did not even inspect it; she simply trusted her with the

necklace and felt awful for the pain she had to endure in order to replace it. This demonstrates her sincerity. As a result, she proved to be a genuine friend.

Or

Discoveries of science can be used for the welfare of mankind as well as for its destruction. How is this applicable to Griffin's scientific discovery?

Explain giving examples from the text. (100 - 150 words) 8 Marks

Ans: Griffin was a researcher. One day, while doing a scientific experiment, he found a liquid that has the capacity to render objects invisible. During his scientific experiment, he discovered this.Griffin, on the other hand, mishandled this liquid and used it to destroy humans, i.e., he used it to set fire to his landowner's mansion. Yes, I agree with the statement. We may relate this statement to Griffin, a great scientist who found a liquid that can make things invisible. However, Griffin was a lawless person who used his discovery for devastation, such as setting fire to his landowner's house, carrying theft, etc., and we can conclude that whether the found thing is useful or damaging is entirely dependent on the users.